Greek Through Reading Excerpts

March 9, 2026

Adapted readings from J. A. Nairn & G. A. Nairn's *Greek Through Reading*, 1974 edition. This book is really special to me — it was a gift from Dr. Hendrickson, the Latin teacher at my high school who got me into Greek. I'd started studying in 2023 after taking his "How to Read Ancient Greek" mini class at summer camp. Two years later, in summer 2025, I took the same mini class, now having finished half of *Alpha to Omega*. He gave me the book there.

College applications prevented me from working through the book for most of 2025. I started working through the book again in May 2026, and hope to finish it by the end of my freshman year in college.

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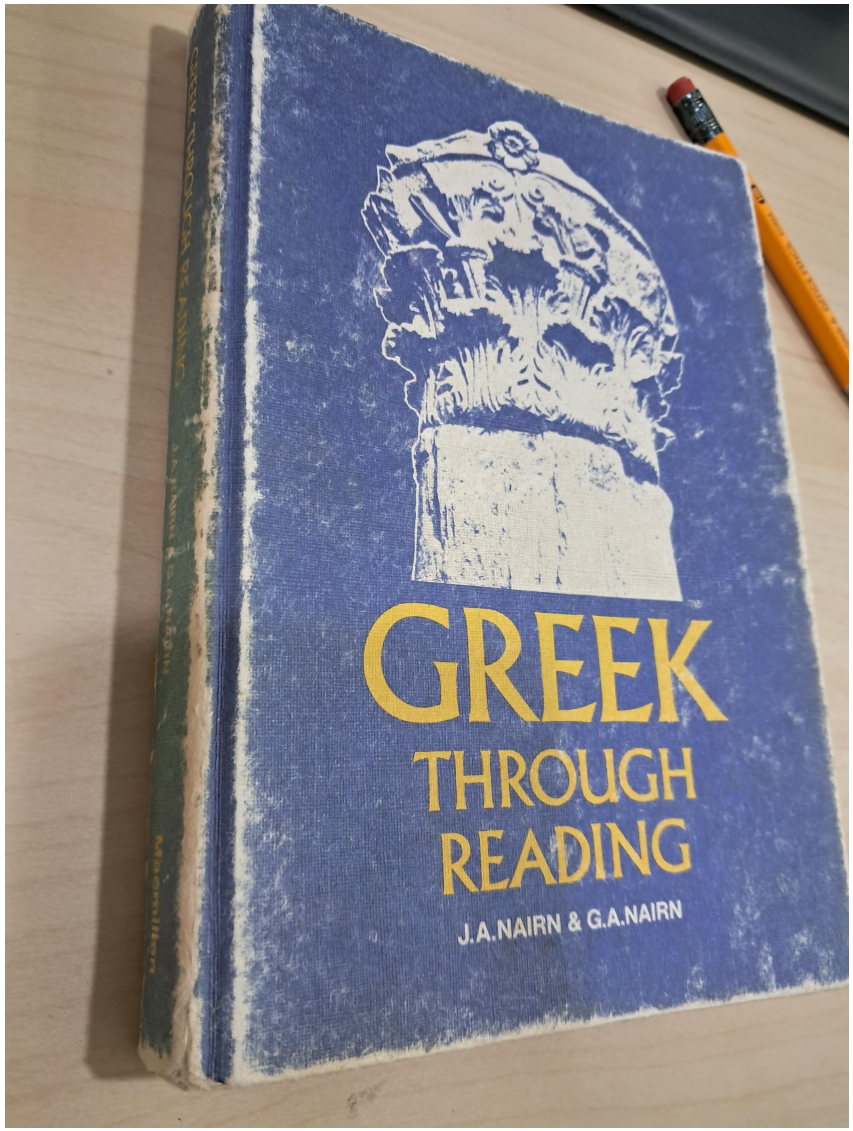


Figure 1: The closest thing to an ancient scroll I have

I. Greece and Athens

1. J. A. Nairn, "Greece"

Ἡ Ἑλλὰς μέρος ἐστὶ τῆς Εὐρώπης. οἰκοῦσι δ᾽ αὐτὴν οἱ Ἕλληνας τοὺς πάλαι διὰ τοῦτο καὶ νῦν τιμῶμεν, ὅτι τήν τ᾽ ἐλευθερίαν ἐφίλουν, καὶ τὴν ἀλήθειαν, καὶ τὸ καλόν. καὶ ὑπὲρ μὲν τῆς ἐλευθερίας ὀλίγοι πρὸς πολλοὺς πολεμοῦντες πολλάκις ἐνίκησαν, τὴν δ᾽ ἀλήθειαν καὶ τὸ καλὸν ζητοῦντες ποιήματα καὶ δράματα καὶ ἱστορίας ἔγραψαν, καὶ ἀνδριάντας ἔγλυψαν καὶ ἱερὰ ᾠκοδόμησαν, ὧν ἔνια καὶ ἐφ᾽ ἡμῶν περίεστιν.

αὕτη ἡ βίβλος περὶ τῶν θ᾽ Ἑλλήνων καὶ περὶ τῶν ἔργων ἀπαγγελεῖ.

Greece is a part of Europe. And the Greeks live there. We now value the Ancient Greeks on account of these, because they were loving freedom, and the truth, and moral things[1]. And on account of freedom the few often conquered the many making war, and seeking truth and morals, wrote poems and plays and histories, and carved statues and erected shrines, of which some now are surviving in our time.[2]

This book will recount both the Greeks and their works.

2. J. A. Nairn, "The Sea"

Τῆς Ἑλλάδος οὐδὲν μέρος πολὺ τῆς θαλάττης ἀπέχει. μεταξὺ γὰρ τῆς Εὐρώπης καὶ τῆς Ἀσίας πολλαὶ νῆσοί εἰσι, καὶ ἐν τῇ χώρᾳ αὐτῇ πολλοὶ λιμένες, ὥστε οἱ ἀπ᾽ Εὐρώπης πρὸς Ἀσίαν πλέοντες γῆν ἀεί ποθ᾽ ὁρῶσιν· ἀγαθοὶ δ᾽ ὄντες ναῦται οἱ Ἕλληνες ἦλθον ἐπὶ τὴν Ἰωνίαν καὶ τὴν Λιβύην, καὶ Αἴγυπτον, καὶ δὴ καὶ ἐπὶ τὴν Βρεταννικήν, καὶ διὰ τοῦ Ἑλλησπόντου

No one of the Greeks is much far from the value of the sea. For between Europe and Asia there are many islands, and many ponds in the very countryside, so that those sailing from Europe towards Asia seldom see the land: and the Greek sailors, being good, came upon Ionia and Libya, and Egypt, and in fact upon Britain, and throughout the Hellespont upon the black

[1] Possibly a reference to democracy and philosophy in particular.

[2] Standard philhellene talk. Pretty exciting introduction!

ἐπὶ τὸν Εὔξεινον πόντον, καὶ ἀποικίας ᾤκισαν. ὡς καλὸν τὸ χρῶμα τῆς ἐκεῖ, τῆς Αἰγαίας θαλάττης! τῷ οἴνῳ προσόμοιον ἔφασαν εἶναι οἱ ποιηταί.

sea, and settled colonies. So beautiful is the color of that place, the Aegean sea! The poets said it was similar to wine.

3. J. A. Nairn, "The Land"

Μικρὰ δὴ χώρα ἡ Ἑλλάς· καὶ πολλὰ μὲν ὄρη ὀλίγα δὲ πεδία ἔχει, ποταμοὺς δ᾽ οὐ μακρούς. τὰ δ᾽ ὄρη, τοὺς Ἕλληνας ἀπ᾽ ἀλλήλων ἀποτέμνοντα, ἀπίστους πρός τοὺς ὁμόρους ἐποίει, ῥᾴδιον γὰρ οὐκ ἦν συνελθεῖν. καὶ πρὸς τοὺς ἔξω πολεμίους τοῦτο μέγαν κίνδυνον παρεῖχεν, ἐπεὶ οὐχ ὡς ἓν ἔθνος ἀλλ᾽ ὡς πόλεις ἑκάστη καθ᾽ ἑκάστην διῆγον. τῶν δὲ πόλεων ὀνόματα τῶν λαμπροτάτων γράψω· Σπάρτη, Ἀθῆναι, Θῆβαι, Ἄργος, Κόρινθος. ἐπολέμουν πρὸς ἀλλήλας αὗται αἱ πόλεις πολλάκις, εἰρήνην δ᾽ ἦγον οὐ πολλάκις.

The Greek land is small: on the one hand, it has many mountains, but it has few plains, and no large rivers. And the rivers, severing the Greeks from each other, were creating distrust against neighbors, for it was not easy to assemble. And this was a great danger outside of wars, because each lived according to each, not separated by race but by cities[3]. I shall write the names of the most famous cities: Sparta, Athens, Thebes, Argos, Corinth. These cities were often at war with each other, and were often not at peace.

4. J. A. Nairn, "Sparta and Athens"

Ἡ μὲν Σπάρτη ἔνεστιν ἐν τῇ τοῦ Πέλοπος νήσῳ, ἣν οἱ Ἕλληνες Πελοπόννησον ἐκάλουν· ἀπέχει δέ τι τῆς θαλάττης. στρατιώτας δ᾽ ἔτρεφεν ἀνδρείους, οἳ πόλεμον ἀπὸ παιδὸς ἤσκουν. ἔτι δ᾽ αἱ γυναῖκες αὐτῶν ἐν τοῖς γυμνασίοις ἔμαθον ἰσχυραὶ εἶναι,

Sparta is in the island of Pelops, which the Greeks call the Peloponnese – it is somewhat far from the sea. They raised brave soldiers, who trained for war from boyhood. Even the women of them [the Spartans] learned in the gymnasium to be brave,

[3] Unsure about this translation.

ὡς πρέπει ταῖς μητράσι στρατιωτῶν.

᾿Αθῆναι δὲ τοὐναντίον [4] πρὸς τῇ θαλάττῃ εἰσίν, οἱ δ᾽ ᾿Αθηναῖοι πλεῖν τὴν θάλατταν ἔμαθον, ὡς ναῦται καὶ ἔμποροι. ἀπὸ δὲ τῶν νεῶν ἐμάχοντο, καὶ μεγάλην δύναμιν ἔσχον, θαλαττοκράτορες ὄντες.

so that they would appear mothers of soldiers.

Athens on the contrary is close to the sea, and the Athenians learned to sail the sea, just as sailors and wayfarers. And they fought from the ships, and held great power, being sea-masters.

5. J. A. Nairn, "Athens"

Ἔτι καὶ νῦν αἱ ᾿Αθῆναι λαμπροτάτη τῆς Ἑλλάδος πόλις· πῶς ᾿Αθήναζε ἐρχόμεθα· κατὰ θάλατταν ῥᾷον ἢ κατὰ γῆν. πλέοντες οὖν εἰς Πειραιᾶ ἀφικνούμεθα, τῶν ᾿Αθηνῶν λιμένα. ἆρα μέλλομεν, ὡς Σωκράτης χρόνῳ ποτε, πομπὴν ὁρᾶν· Πλάτων γὰρ ἔγραψεν ὡς ἐν Πειραιεῖ, ἐν τῇ θυσίᾳ θεοῦ τινος, Σωκράτους παρόντος, νεανίαι ἔδραμον [5] δᾶδας ἔχοντες ἐν ταῖς χερσί, καὶ τρέχοντες παρέδοσαν τὰς δᾷδας ἕκαστος τῷ πλησίον, καὶ ἐκεῖνος ὡσαύτως τῷ πλησίον, τοῦτο δὲ τῆς νυκτὸς ἐγένετο.

Even now Athens is the most magnificient city of Greece; how do we go to Athens? Easily by the sea or by earth. Then sailing, we arrive at Piraeus, harbor of athens. Are we about to see, just as Socrates once upon a time, the splendor? For Plato wrote that in the Piraeus, in the temple of some god, with Socrates present, the youth ran, holding torches in their hands, and running, handed over each torch to a bystander [6], and just so they to a bystander, and this took place by night.

6. J. A. Nairn, "The Acropolis"

᾿Εν δὲ ταῖς ᾿Αθήναις ἄκρα τίς ἐστιν, ἣν ᾿Ακρόπολιν ὀνομάζουσι· διατείνει δ᾽ αφ᾽ ἡλίου ἀνατέλλοντος ἐφ᾽ ἥλιον δύνοντα· ἐπὶ δὲ

And in Athens is something tall, which they call the Acropolis: it faces away from the rising sun and faces the setting sun[7].

[4] τὸ ἐναντίον : on the contrary

[5] Strong aorist of τρέχω

[6] Plato wrote about this torch ceremony in *Republic* (Book 1)

ταύτης τῆς ἄκρας ἱερά ἐστιν, ὧν τὸ μέγιστον Παρθενὼν καλεῖται, ἱερὸν γάρ ἐστιν τῆς θεοῦ Ἀθηνᾶς, ἣ παρθένος διέμεινεν. τετράγωνον δὲ τὸ ἱερόν, καὶ πολλοὺς ἔχει στύλους. ἐν δὲ τῷ ἄνωθεν μέρει ξόανά ἐστιν, ἔργον τοῦ Φειδίου. τῇ μὲν ἡ Ἀθηνᾶ γεννᾶται, θυγάτηρ οὖσα τοῦ Διός, τῇ δ΄ ἐρίζει πρὸς τὸν Ποσειδῶνα, πότερος ἄρξει τῆς Ἀττικῆς

And upon this tall building are shrines, of which the greatest is called the Parthenon, for it is the shrine to the goddess Athena, who remains a maiden[8]. The shrine is four-sided, and has many pillars. And in the upper part are xoana [9], the work of Phidias. On the one side Athena is born, being the daughter of Zeus, on the other side she challenges Poseidon – which of the two should lead Athens.

7. Pindar, "Praise of Athens" (fr. 76, p. 556, trans. Sandys)

Αἵ τε λιπαραὶ καὶ ἰοστέφανοι καὶ ἀοίδιμοι,
Ἑλλάδος ἔρεισμα, κλειναὶ Ἀθᾶναι, δαιμόνιον προλίεθρον.

O, the gleaming, and the violet-crowned, and sung in story:
the bulwark of Hellas, famous Athens, city divine.

8. J. A. Nairn, "Athens: The Parthenon"

Ἐπὶ δὲ τῶν τοῦ ἱεροῦ τειχῶν ἄνω λίθινα ζῷά ἐστιν, ἐν πομπῇ, τιμὴν φέροντα τῇ θεῷ Ἀθηνᾷ. ἐνθάδε μὲν οἱ θεοὶ ὁρῶσι τὴν πομπήν, Ζεύς τε καὶ Ἥρα καὶ Ἥφαιστος. καὶ μὴν καὶ ὁ Ἄρης, καίπερ τοῦ πολέμου θεὸς ὤν, μένει ἡσυχῇ. ἐκεῖ δ΄ ὁ ἱερεὺς τῆς θεοῦ, πέπλον λαβὼν ἐν ταῖς χερσί, δίδωσι παιδί· νέος δ΄ οὗτος ὁ πεπλος, ἀντὶ τοῦ παλαιοῦ τῇ θεῷ φερόμενος. πέμπουσι

And up along the walls of the shrine there are marble figures, in escort, doing honour to the goddess Athena. Here the gods see the pomp, Zeus and Hera and Hephaestus. And even Ares, although being the god of war, rests at peace. And there the priest of the gods, holding garments in hands, offers [it] to the child: this new garment is carried to the goddess in exchange

[7] The Parthenon's main entrance faces East.
[8] maiden – παρθένος . Parthenon – Παρθενών .
[9] wooden effigies

δὲ τὸν πέπλον νεανίαι, καὶ παρθένοι, [10] καὶ ἱππῆς, [11] καὶ αὐλητρίδες, [12] καὶ κιθαριστρίαι, [13] ἆρ᾽ ἑώρακας· ἔνεστι γὰρ ἔνια τῶν ζῴων ἐν τῇ πατρίδι ἡμῶν.

for the old. Did you see the young men escort the garment, and maidens, and charioteers, and flute-players, and kithara-players? For some of the images are in our own country. [14]

9. J. A. Nairn, "Athens: The Marketplace"

Ἰδοὺ ἡ τῶν Ἀθηνῶν ἀγορά· μεστὴ δὲ περὶ μεσμηβρίαν τῶν ὠνουμένων. πρῷ δ᾽ ἥκοντες ἑστᾶσι βλέποντες τό τ᾽ ἔλαιον καὶ τὸ ὄξος καὶ τοὺς πρὸς τὸ πῦρ ἄνθρακας, καὶ τοὺς πρὸς τὸ δεῖπνον ἰχθῦς. πολλοὶ δὲ τῶν παρόντων διαλέγονται ἀλλήλοις, νεώτερόν τι ἢ ἀκούειν βουλόμενοι. ἴσως δ᾽ ἀκούουσι τῶν σοφιστῶν τῶν διδασκόντων δὴ τὴν σοφίαν. ἆρα πάρεστι Σωκράτης· ναί, καὶ περιεστᾶσι πολλοί, ἐλέγχει γὰρ τοὺς σοφιστάς, καὶ φανερὸν ποιεῖ ὅτι δοκοῦντες εἰδέναι τι τῷ ὄντι οὐκ ἴσασιν.

Look at the marketplace of Athens: it is filled with buyers around midday. In the morning they stood gathering to see the olive oil and the vinegar and charcoal for the fire, and fish for the meal. Many of those standing conversed with others, wishing to hear something newer. They listen equally to the scholars and the ones professing to teach wisdom. Is Socrates present? Yes, and others stand around, for he questions scholars, and shows clearly that those assuming to know something in reality do not know[15].

[10] maidens

[11] charioteers (cf. ἵππος "horse")

[12] flute-players

[13] kithara-players (κιθάρα : 7-stringed version of the lyre)

[14] The British Museum famously (and controversially) holds many of the Parthenon sculptures.

[15] A related quote appears in Plato's *Apology* 21d, where Socrates is quoted to say ἃ μὴ οἶδα οἴομαι εἰδέναι – "I don't assume that I know whatever I don't know."

10. J. A. Nairn, "Athens: The Theatre of Dionysus"

Ἔστιν ἔτι καὶ νῦν Ἀθήνησι θέατρον ὃ Διονύσου καλεῖται· φέρει δὲ τὸ ὄνομα τοῦ θεοῦ ὃν ἐτίμων ἐν τοῖς δράμασιν. τοῦτων δὲ τῶν δραμάτων τὰ μὲν τραγῳδίαι, τὰ δὲ κωμῳδίαι. ἤθελον γὰρ οἱ Ἀθηναῖοι οὐ μόνον δακρύειν ἐπὶ ταῖς τραγῳδίαις, ἀλλὰ καὶ γελᾶν ἐπὶ ταῖς κωμῳδίαις.

And even now there is a theatre in Athens which is called the theatre of Dionysus: it bears its name from the god whom they honored in plays. Of these plays some were tragedies, others were comedies. For the Athenians wished not only to cry at tragedies, but also to laugh at comedies.

Ἆρα γιγνώσκετε τάδε τὰ ὀνόματα· Αἰσχύλος, Σοφοκλῆς, Εὐριπίδης. οὗτοι τραγῳδίας ἔγραψαν καὶ Ἀριστοφάνην ἀκήκοας· οὗτος λαμπρὸς ἦν κωμῳδοποιός. πολλὰ τῶν ἔργων αὐτῶν ἔτι καὶ νῦν περίεστιν, ἄλλα [16] δὲ διὰ τὸν χρόνον διέφθαρται.

Do you know the names? Aeschylus, Sophocles, Euripides. They wrote tragedies. And have you heard of Aristophanes? He was a great writer of comedies. Many of his work still survives, but others have perished through time.

11. J. A. Nairn, "Athens: Head of a League of Nations"

Μετὰ τὴν Σαλαμῖνι μάχηω, οἱ Ἀθηναῖοι, τῷ ναυτικῷ ὑπερέχοντες, συμμάχους εἶχον πολλὰς πόλεις, μάλιστα δὲ τῶν νησιωτῶν. καὶ ὁμοία ἐφρόνουν διὰ τὸν τῶν Περσῶν φόβον. ἦν δὲ τεταγμένον ἑκάστην πόλιν ναῦς τινας τοῖς Ἀθηναίοις παρέχειν, καὶ τὰς ναῦς κωλύειν τοὺς Πέρσας μὴ εἰς τὴν Ἑλλάδα εἰσβάλλειν· ὕστερον δὲ ἀντὶ νεῶν χρήματα εἰσέφερον, φόρον ἐνιαύσιον.

In the midst of the battle of Salamis, the Athenians, with superior naval power, were allied with many cities, the best of the islands. And they were in agreement on account of the fear of Persians. Each established city presented some ships to the Athenians, and the ships planned to prevent the Persians invading into Greece[17]. But the latter [the Persians] bought ships in exchange for money, with yearly tributes.

Ἀλλ᾽ οἱ Ἀθηναῖοι τοῖς συμμάχοις οὐ πρεπόντως ἐχρήσαντο.

But the Athenians with their allies fought not gracefully. For,

[16] From ἄλλος ("others"). Distinguish from ἀλλά ("but") by position of accent.

τὰ γὰρ χρήματα τὰ πρὸς πόελμον διδόμενα εἰς ἑαυτοὺς ἀνήλισκον, ὥστε οὐκέτι συμμαχία ἀλλ᾽ Ἀθηναίων ἀρχὴ κατέστη. τέλος δ᾽ ἀπέστησαν οἱ σύμμαχοι, καὶ οἱ Λακεδαιμόνιοι μετ᾽ αὐτῶν εἶλον τὰς Ἀθήνας. οὕτως ἠφανίσθη ἡ τῶν Ἀθηναίων ἀρχή.

giving money in exchange for war, they spent against themselves, because authority of the allies was never set except by the Athenians. Eventualy the allies stood away, and with them, the Spartans conquered the Athenians. Thus the authority of the Athenians faded away.

[17] Unsure about this translation.

II. Gods and Goddesses

12. J. A. Nairn, "Zeus and Hera"

Μέγιστος δὲ τῶν Ἑλλήνων θεὸς ὁ Ζεύς, πατὴρ θεῶν τε καὶ ἀνθρώπων καλούμενος. ἔλεγον δ΄ ὅτι μετὰ τῶν ἄλλων θεῶν ἐπὶ κορυφῆς ὄρους τινος διάγει, ᾧ ὄνομα Ὄλυμπος. οἱ δ΄ ἄλλοι θεοὶ περικάθηνται αὐτόν, καὶ συμβουλεύουσιν, κρίνει δ΄ ὁ Ζεύς. κεραυνὸν δὲ φέρει, δι΄ οὗ κολάζει τοὺς ἁμαρτάνοντας. ἀδελφοὺς δ΄ ἔχει δύο, τὸν μὲν Αΐδην, τῶν νερτέρων θεόν, τὸν δὲ Ποσειδώνα, θεὸν τῆς θαλάσσης. ἀδελφὴν δ΄ ἔχει, ἣ καὶ γυνὴ ἦν τοῦ Διός, τὴν Ἥραν. ὄρνις δὲ Διὸς ὁ ἀετός.

The greatest of the Hellenic gods is Zeus, both the father of the gods and honored by men. And they said that, with the other gods, he lived upon the peak of some mountain, whose name was Olympus. The other gods sit around him, and counsel, and Zeus decides. He bears lightning bolts, by which he punishes the sinners.[18] He has two brothers, one of which is Hades, god of the dead, and the other is Poseidon, god of the sea. He has a sister, Hera, who is the god's wife. The god's bird is an eagle.

13. J. A. Nairn, "Athena"

Μεγάλην εἶχε τιμὴν Ἀθήνησιν ἡ Ἀθηνᾶ, ἣ καὶ τὸ ὄνομα ἔδωκε τῇ πόλει. εἶπον [19] δὲ ὅτι ἐκ τῆς κεφαλῆς τοῦ πατρὸς αὐτῆς, τοῦ Διός, ἐξῆλθε. καὶ ὡς πρὸς τὸν πόλεμον δόρυ ἔφερεν ἡ Ἀθηνᾶ ἐν τῇ δεξιᾷ, ἐν δὲ τῇ ἀριστερᾷ ἀσπίδα· ἐπὶ δὲ τοῦ κράνους ἐκάθητο γλαῦξ· σημεῖον δ΄ αὕτη ἡ ὄρνις τῆς σοφίας, θεὸς δὲ σοφίας ἡ Ἀθηνᾶ.

The greatest respect from the Athenians is possessed by Athena, who gave her name to the city. They say that she sprung from the head of her father, Zeus. And so Athena bore a war spear on her right, a shield on her left; upon her helmet is seated an owl; the sign of the goddess and the bird of wisdom, for Athena [is] the goddess of wisdom.

τῶν δ΄ ἀνθρώπων φίλτατος τῇ Ἀθηνᾷ ὁ Ὀδυσσεύς, ὡς εὑρεῖν

The most beloved of men to Athena is Odysseus, as you can find

[18] The idea of sinners being punished seems like a more modern notion – in the myths, the gods are more flawed and often smite mortals at whim. There might be something to be said about the psyche of the society that created these myths, coming out of the hardships of the Greek Dark Ages?

[19] Singular verb for neuter subject?

πάρεστιν ἐν τῇ ᾽Οδυσσείᾳ τοῦ ῾Ομήρου.

in the Odyssey of Homer.

14. J. A. Nairn, "Poseidon"

θεὸς ἦν τῆς θαλάσσης ὁ Ποσειδῶν, περὶ οὗ ἔλεγον ὅτι κυανέας ἔχοι τὰς τρίχας, καὶ ὅτι ἐν ὀχήματι αὐτὸν θηρία θαλάσσια φέροι ἐπὶ τῶν κυμάτων, τρίαιναν δ΄ ἔχοι, σημεῖον τῆς ἀρχῆς. καὶ σεισμούς – πολλοὺς δ΄ ἔχει ἡ Ἑλλάς – ἐποίει, ὡς ἐνόμιζον, ὁ Ποσειδῶν σείων τὴν τρίαιναν. λέλεκται δ΄ ἄνωθεν ὅτι ἤρισε πρὸς τὴν ᾽Αθηνᾶν πότερος ἄρξοι τῆς ᾽Αττικῆς. τότε δ΄ ἐνίκησεν ᾽Αθηνᾶ, ἐλάαν γενέσθαι ποιοῦσα, ὁ δὲ Ποσειδῶν τῇ τριαίνῃ θαλάσσιον ὕδωρ ἐν τῇ ᾽Ακροπόλει ἐποίησεν.

Poseidon was the god of the sea, who they say possesses dark-blue threads, and [is] in a chariot born by sea beasts upon the waves, and possessing a trident, the mark of the god. And he created earthquakes (Greece has many), which they thought was Poseidon shaking his trident. It has been said that he contended with Athena from above concerning which would rule the Attic land. He drove to create something, and Poseidon with his trident created sea water in the Acropolis.

15. Apollodorus, "Phoebus Apollo and Artemis" (*The Library,* I.iv.I, etc.)

ὁ ᾽Απόλλων, Διὸς [20] υἱος καὶ Λητοῦς, θεὸς ἦν φέγγους. τοῦ δ΄ ἡλίου ζωὴν διδόντος, τῶν νεανιῶν φύλαξ ἦν ᾽Απόλλων, ἀγῶσί τε καὶ τῇ παλαίστρᾳ ἐπισκοπῶν. σημεῖον δὲ τούτου τόξον φέρει καὶ φαρέτραν. ἔτι δὲ καὶ τῆς μαντικῆς θεὸς ὢν Δελφοὺς ᾤκει, ἡ δ΄ ἱέρεια αὐτοῦ τοῖς ἀνθρώποις τὰ μέλλοντα ἔσεσθαι προεῖπεν. ἐπεὶ δὲ ἡ μαντικὴ καὶ ἡ μουσικὴ κοινόν τι ἔχειν φαίνονται, λύραν φέρει, καὶ ἐν ταῖς τῶν θεῶν θυσίαις φορμίζει,

Apollo, son of Zeus and Leto, was the god of light. Having gifted life of the sun, Apollo was the protector of young men, overseeing both contests and palaestra[21]. As his sign he carries a bow and quiver. And yet he was the god of seers, dwelling in Delphi, and his priestess foretold future events to men. Since divination and music seem to possess common things, he carries a lyre, and he plays [the lyre] in sacrifices of the gods, and

[20] Genitive of Zeus

καὶ τὸν τῶν Μουσῶν χορὸν εἰσάγει. καὶ μὴν τοῖς ἰατροῖς, ὡς μάντις, τέχνην ἐντίθησι τοῦ τὰς νόσους εὑρίσκειν, καὶ ἰᾶσθαι.

he drives the choir of the Muses. And to doctors, just as a seer, he gave skill of discovering diseases, and to cure [them].

Ἄρτεμις, ἡ τοῦ Ἀπόλλωνος ἀδελφή, κυνηγέτις οὖσα, τὰς ὕλας ᾤκει, φαρέτραν καὶ τόξον καὶ αὐτὴ ἔχουσα.

Artemis, the sister of Apollo, being a huntress, dwelled in the woods, she holding both quiver and bow.

16. Apollodorus, "Hermes" (*The Library*, III.x.2)

Ὁ δ᾽ Ἑρμῆς Διὸς καὶ Μαίας υἱὸς ἦν, ἐν Ἀρξαδίᾳ, ποιμνῶν τε καὶ ἀγελῶν χώρᾳ, γεγονώς. ἕῳ δὲ γεννηθείς, μεσμηβρίᾳ ἐφόρμιζεν, ἑσμέρᾳ δὲ τοὺς τοῦ Ἀπόλλωνος βοῦς ἔκλεψε. τὴν δὲ λύραν ἐποίησεν ἐκ νώτου χελώνης, ἐπὶ τούτου τὰς ἑπτὰ χορδὰς τανύσας. τοὺς δὲ βοῦς ἔκλεψεν ἐπ᾽ ὀπίσω ἐλάσας, ὥστε τὰ ἴχνη αὐτῶν πρὸς οἶκον τρέπεσθαι δοκεῖν. πρὸς δὲ τῇ λύρᾳ καὶ τὴν σύριγγα ἐξεῦρε. καὶ μὴν τῶν θεῶν ἄγγελος ὢν τοὺς ἀνθρώπους ἦγε τὴν ἐσχάτην εἰς Ἅιδου πορείαν.

And Hermes was the son of Zeus and Maia, in Arkadia, having been born to the land of herds and herders. And having been born, at dawn, when noon was coming, in the day he stole the cows of Apollo. He created the lyre from the back of a tortoise, pon which he stretched seven strings. And he stole the cattle, driven backwards, so that their footprints are seen to be placed from the house. And he discovered the lyre and the panpipes. Messenger of the gods, he brings their words to men [and leads] the journey [of the] dead into Hades.

17. Apollodorus, "Demeter" (*The Library*, I.v.I)

Τὴν Δήμητρα ἐνόμιζον οἱ Ἕλληνες γῆν μητέρα εἶναι. ἐδίδαξε δ᾽ ἡ θεὸς αὕτη ἀνθρώπους τὸν σῖτον θεραπεύειν, ἔν τε τῇ Θετταλίᾳ καὶ τῇ Σικελίᾳ, ἐκεῖ γὰρ πολὺς ἦν σῖτος. θυγατέρα δ᾽

The Greeks held Demeter to be mother of earth. And the goddess herself taught men to cultivate grain, both in Thessaly and in Sicily, for there was many grain there. She had a daughter,

[21] Greek wrestling school

εἶχε τὴν Περσεφόνην· παρθένος δ᾽ οὖσα ἥδε συνέλεγεν ἄνθη, ἥρπασε δ᾽ αὐτὴν Αἴδης, ὁ νερτέρων θεός. ἀγανακτοῦσα δ᾽ ἡ Δημήτηρ οὐκ εἴα τὸν σῖτον ἀκμάζειν, ὥστε λιμῷ παθεῖν τοὺς ἀνθρώπους. ἔπαυσαν δὲ τοῦτο οἱ θεοί, ὑποσχόμενοι τὴν Περσεφόνην ἑκάστου ἔτους μέρος μετὰ τῆς μητρὸς διάξειν.

Persephone: the maiden, being there, gathering flowers, Hades, god of the dead, snatched her. And Demeter, being furious, did not allow grain to bloom, so that humans underwent famine. And the gods ended this, promising that Persephone should spend a part of every year with her mother.

18. Apollodorus, "Aphrodite" (*The Library,* I.iii.I)

Ἡ Ἀφροδίτη, Διὸς καὶ Διώνης θυγάτηρ, θεὸς ἦν τοῦ ἔρωτος. Ἡσίοδος δὲ ὁ ποιητὴς λέγει ὅτι ἀπ᾽ ἀφροῦ τῆς θαλάττης ἐγένετο, καὶ ἐπὶ τὴν Κύπρον – φιλτάτη δὲ ἡ νῆσος τῇ θεῷ – ὑπὸ τῶν κυμάτων ἠνέχθη. ἐρῶσα δὲ καλοῦ νεανίου, τοῦ Ἀδώνιδος, ἀποθανόντος ὑπὸ κάπρου ἐκείνου, βαρέως ἔφερεν. καὶ μὴν πρὸς Ἥραν καὶ Ἀθηνᾶν ἤρισεν ἡ Ἀφροδίτη περὶ τοῦ κάλλους· ἔκρινε δὲ Πάρις, Πριάμου υἱός, ὃς τὸ μῆλον Ἀφροδίτῃ ἔνειμεν. ἡ δ᾽ αὐτῷ Ἑλένην, καλλίστην γυναικῶν, ἔδωκεν. ἡ δὲ θεὸς ἢ μῆλον φέρει, ἢ κάτοπτρον, ἢ πελειάδα, ὁ δ᾽ υἱός, Ἔρως, τόξον καὶ φαρέτραν ἔχει.

Aphrodite, daughter of Zeus and Dione[22], was the goddess of love. And Hesiod the poet said that she was born of the foam of the sea, and upon Cyprus – the most beloved island to the goddess – she was carried by the waves. And she loved a handsome young man, Adonis, who was killed by a wild boar, and she felt sorrow. Aphrodite competed with both Hera and Athena concerning the most beautiful: and Paris decided, son of Priam, who gave the apple to Aphrodite. And she gave to him Helen, the most beautiful of women. And the goddess carries either an apple, or a mirror, or doves, and her son, Eros, has a bow and quiver.

[22] A titan that appears in old myths

19. "Love's Sweetness" (*Anthologia Palatina*, v. 170)

Ἥδιον οὐδὲν Ἔρωτος, ἃ δ᾽ ὄλβια, δεύτερα πάντα
ἐστίν· ἀπὸ στόματος δ᾽ ἔπτυσα καὶ τὸ μέλι.
Τοῦτο λέγει Νοσσίς· τὴν δ᾽ ἡ Κύπρις οὐκ ἐφίλησεν
οὐκ οἶδεν κείνης τἄνθεα ποῖα ῥόδα.

Nothing is sweeter than love, a blessing, everything is second,
I even spat out the honey from my mouth.
Thus said Nossis – those whom Aphrodite does not love,
they know not what kind of flower, what rose.

20. Sappho, "The Apple Pickers" (Smyth, *Greek Melic Poets*, p. 33)

Οἷον τὸ γλυκύμαλον ἐρεύθεται ἄκρῳ ἐπ᾽ ὄσδῳ,
ἄκρον ἐπ᾽ ἀκροτάτῳ, λελάθοντο [23] δὲ μαλοδροπῆες,
οὐ μὰν ἐκλελάθοντ᾽, ἀλλ᾽ οὐκ ἐδύναντ᾽ ἐπίκεσθαι.

And such the apple reddened upon the high branch,
High upon the highest, the apple-pickers forgot–
No, they didn't forget, but were unable to reach.[24]

[23] Reduplication happens in the aorist of this dialect; Translate like ἐλάθοντο

[24] Like a wedding song fragment – the bride takes the role of the apple, and no one can "take" her except the groom. (Prof. Levaniouk)

III. Heroes

21. Apollodorus, "Heracles" (*The Library*, II.iv.9)

Ἡρακλῆς ἦν Διὸς καὶ Ἀλκιμήνης υἱός, καὶ ἐν σπαργάνοις ἔτι ὢν οὕτως ἰσχυρὸς ἦν ὥστε ὄφεις ἄγχειν δύνασθαι οὓς ἔπεμφεν Ἥρα ὡς διαφθεροῦντας αὐτόν. φιλάνθρωπος δ᾽ ὤν, πολλὰ καὶ ἀγαθὰ ἔργα ἔδρασεν ἄνα οἱ ἄνθρωποι βίον ἔχοιεν εὐδαιμονέστερον. ἐν δὲ τῇ Ἡρακλέους αἱρέσει Ξενοφῶν λέγει ὅτι νεανίᾳ ὄντι τῷ Ἡρακλεῖ δύο γυναῖκες ἠπάντησας, ὧν ἡ μὲν ἡδονὴν ἡ δὲ ἀρετὴν προύθηκεν. ἀρετὴν δ᾽ ἀνθ᾽ ἡδονῆς ἑλομένῳ φύλαξ ἐγένετο Ἀθηνᾶ. ἀλλ᾽ Ἥρα, ἀεὶ δυσμενὴς οὖσα, δώδεκα ἄθλους ὑπομένειν ἠνάγκασεν, ὧν εἷς ἦν τὸν λέοντα τὸν τῆς Νεμέας ἀποκτείνειν. λέοντος δὲ δορὰν περιεβάλετο καὶ ῥόπαλον ἔφερεν.

Heracles was the son of Zeus and Alcmene, and still in his swaddling-clothes, being thus violent, just so he was able to strangle a snake Hera sent to destroy him. And being kind-hearted, he did many and good work so that men might have happier life. And Xenophon said in "The Choice of Heracles" that Heracles, being a young man, met two women, of which one offered comfort and another offered glory. He chose glory over comfort, it came to happen [that] Athena [was his] guardian.[25] But Hera, being hostile still, send labors he was forced to bear, of which one was to kill the Nemean Lion. He wore the skin of the lion and carried a club.

[25] Unsure about this translation